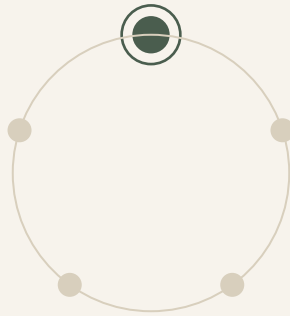


ONE OF THE 5 HIDDEN TRIGGERS



The Stillness Trigger Herb Formulary

*The herbs I trust for this trigger, each with its
dose, why it helps, and the cautions that matter.*

by Joel Polley, RN

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The Stillness Trigger Herb Formulary

These are the circulation and vessel herbs I trust for the Stillness Trigger, where the goal is to bring flexibility and flow back to vessels that have gone too long without a movement signal. They are educational and meant to work alongside your doctor, never instead of your doctor.

The universal rule lives at the top of every formulary: add ONE at a time, check your blood pressure daily, and tell your doctor everything you are taking. The herbs support the work, but the movement break and the daily walk are the engine. Let the botanicals ride alongside them, not in place of them.

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS EVERY HERB HERE

Add ONE at a time. Check your blood pressure daily. Tell your doctor everything you are taking. If you are on BP medication these can lower your pressure further, which is the goal under monitoring; if readings run consistently below about 110/70 or you feel dizzy, call your doctor about your medication. Never stop or change a prescription on your own.

The Formulary

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Hawthorn (Crataegus) <i>The circulation keystone</i>	Joel's source names hawthorn as the circulation keystone but does not specify a milligram dose. Follow product labeling and your doctor's guidance for the exact amount, taken with food. Begin with this herb and give it time: its effect builds gradually over weeks, so consistency matters far more than a big dose.	The traditional heart and vessel herb, used for generations to support healthy circulation and the tone and flexibility of the blood vessels. It is the botanical partner to your daily movement: the movement sends the signal, the hawthorn supports the vessel that receives it. A slow, steady worker you notice over weeks, not hours.	Hawthorn works on the same systems as several heart and blood pressure medications. If you take digoxin, or any blood pressure or heart medication, talk with your doctor before you start. Introduce it alone, monitor your BP daily, and tell your doctor you are taking it.
Hibiscus (Hibiscus sabdariffa) <i>The daily tea</i>	One or two cups of hibiscus tea through the day, in place of the caffeine you set down. A simple, pleasant daily ritual rather than a measured capsule.	Traditionally used to support healthy fluid balance and circulation. Many people find it a calm, satisfying swap for coffee that also works with this trigger rather than against it, gently supporting the vessels while you sip.	Because hibiscus can lower blood pressure, it can add to the effect of BP medication, so monitor daily. It is traditionally avoided in pregnancy, so if you are pregnant or nursing, check with your doctor first. As always, introduce it on its own and tell your doctor.

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Magnesium glycinate <i>The vessel-wall relaxer</i>	300 to 400 mg daily, with dinner or before bed. Glycinate is the gold-standard form for absorption and comfort. Avoid magnesium oxide, which your body barely absorbs.	Magnesium relaxes the smooth muscle in your blood-vessel walls so your arteries can open more easily, and it corrects one of the most common deficiencies in people with high blood pressure. It works quietly alongside the movement and the nitric-oxide foods, all pushing the vessels toward relaxation.	If you take a calcium-channel blocker such as amlodipine, magnesium works on a similar pathway, so monitor daily. Magnesium is cleared by the kidneys, so if you have reduced kidney function or kidney disease, talk with your doctor before supplementing and let your readings and your doctor guide the amount.
Cayenne (Capsicum) <i>The circulation spark</i>	Start with a tiny pinch, in food or stirred into warm water. Build only slowly, and only if it sits well with you. A little goes a long way with this one.	The traditional circulation spark, used for generations to support circulation and warmth and to get the blood moving. It pairs naturally with a trigger about sluggish flow, but it is the one to treat most gently, starting tiny.	Cayenne can add to the effect of blood thinners, so if you take one, clear it with your doctor before starting. Go easy if your stomach is sensitive, since it can irritate. Introduce it alone, in the smallest amount, and tell your doctor.
Beetroot <i>The nitric-oxide food</i>	Food first: eat beets or drink beet juice for their natural nitric-oxide support. If you use a powdered form, follow the product labeling and your doctor's guidance for the amount.	Beets are one of the richest plant sources of the raw material your body uses to make nitric oxide, the signal that tells your arteries to relax and open, the very signal your movement breaks are switching back on. Food and beetroot push the same lever from two directions.	Generally gentle as a food. Beets can turn urine or stool a harmless reddish color, which can be startling but is not a concern. If you use a concentrated powder, treat it like a supplement: introduce it on its own, monitor daily, and tell your doctor, especially if you are on BP medication.

DAILY SUPPORTS (FREE, AND THE BACKBONE)

- A short movement break every 60 to 90 minutes, even just two minutes, to keep the signal flowing to your vessels all day long. This is the keystone.
- A 20-minute unhurried walk in daylight each day, for the movement signal and the sunlight that supports your whole rhythm.
- Calf raises and sit-to-stands during idle moments, such as TV commercials or phone calls; seated ankle pumps and marching count just as much if standing is limited.
- A tall glass of water with each movement break, since dehydration thickens the blood and raises the load on your vessels.
- Ending your shower with 30 seconds of cool water, a simple hydrotherapy that gives circulation a gentle wake-up.
- A prayer walk when you want one, moving your body while you hand over the day: "they shall walk and not faint" (Isaiah 40:31).
- No caffeine; swap it for hibiscus tea, which supports this trigger instead of working against it.

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